

Delaware County Commissioners Meeting April 7th 2025

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=sty_NGfuGhc
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Delaware County Commission Meeting Summary

Meeting Date: April 7, 2025

Presiding Officer: Commission President

1. Pre-Meeting Hearings & Committee Work Sessions

The transcript does not indicate any statutory public hearings or committee work sessions held immediately prior to calling the regular meeting to order. This section is omitted.

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** The Delaware County Commission meeting was called to order by the presiding officer at [00:09:01](#) on April 7, 2025.
- **Attendance:** Members and staff present include the Commission President, Commissioner Brandy, Commissioner Reagan, County Attorney John, and various department heads. Specific individual roll call responses are noted in votes.

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:**
 - 00:00:30 Opening statements and roll call.
 - 00:01:41 **Employee of the Month Recognitions:**
 - Sherry Chase and Chief Deputy Delaware County Assessor's Office presented Angie Pretty (10 years of service, Level 1 Certified Indiana Assessor Appraiser) as Employee of the Month.
 - Chief Hansard recognized Nikki Reed, a probation officer with 35 years of county service (30 as a probation officer), as Justice Center Employee of the Month.
- **Approval of Minutes:** 00:20:00 The minutes of the March 17 commissioner meeting were presented with minor corrections and **Approved by Voice Vote.**

4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- 00:04:10 **Tabled Business: EMvA Provisions & Economic Development Agreements (EDAs)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Commissioners and County Attorney.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Discussion regarding economic development agreements (EDAs) and tax abatements for solar projects (Gaston project with Enogy, Albany project with Paul/National Grid). Commissioners discussed establishing a standard municipal rate (e.g., \$3,500 per megawatt per year for 10 years) directed to the county terminal fund. Review of draft zoning ordinance amendments regarding solar setbacks (maintaining 500-foot setbacks) to be sent to the planning commission.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Taken off the table and set for review/voting at the next meeting.
- 00:13:18 **Contract: Fire Protection & Extinguisher Services**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Leslie Redard (Fire Protection Partner / local family business since 1946) & Commissioners.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Presentation of a 20% discounted pricing structure for county buildings (911 Center, EMS, County Building, Highway Department, Justice Center). Addresses previous audit findings at the Justice Center regarding overdue hydro-tests and missing inspection tags. Competing proposal noted from Simplex.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Taken under advisement for further review.
- 00:20:33 **Presentation: Muncie Land Bank Collaboration**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Nate Howard, Executive Director of Muncie Land Bank.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Proposal to expand the Land Bank's service area to all of Delaware County via an interlocal agreement, systematize the right to acquire

unsold tax sale properties, and secure county funding commitments (\$2.8 million over 5 years requested) to combat blighted and abandoned properties.

- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Received presentation; motion to table the interlocal agreement for further research. **Approved by Voice Vote.**
- **00:40:55 Property Acquisition Request: 804 & 806 East Washington Street**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Albany Kelly, Founder of "One of Us" Support Groups (nonprofit established 2023).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Request regarding property acquisition for a nonprofit headquarters and community support group space on Willow Street. County Attorney confirmed tax-exempt status.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion to table for further research. **Approved by Voice Vote.**
- **00:46:06 Project Presentation: Cardinal Greenway Mural Cleanup**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Rich Sagan, Cardinal Greenway Board President & appointee.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Proposal to restart a program partnering with local artists (Aaron Roberts, Leon Crosby) to paint murals on bridge underpasses and living walls along the Cardinal Greenway and White River Greenway to combat graffiti and blight. Artists agreed to remove/replace work if stakeholders are dissatisfied or if vandalized.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** **Approved by Voice Vote.**
- **00:52:37 Agreement: Foundry Row Apartments PILOT Agreement**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Representative for Ryan Kelly / Development Director.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Finalization of a Payment in Lieu of Taxes (PILOT) agreement for the Foundry Row Apartments affordable housing project on South Cowan Road (IHCD tax credit program, 40-year affordability commitment, starting at \$30,000/year). County Council previously passed the supporting ordinance.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** **Approved by Voice Vote.**
- **00:48:47 (Note: Chronological sequence in transcript) Authorization: Delaware County Mental Health Facility Kitchen Permitting**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mark Freeman.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Request for a permission slip for L.I. Technologies (subcontractor for kitchen equipment) to file required Department of Homeland Security and state permits for the serving kitchen at the Mental Health Facility.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** **Approved by Voice Vote.**
- **00:58:16 Road Right-of-Way Dedication**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** County Staff / Presenter.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Administrative subdivision dividing 1.16 acres, requiring the dedication of road right-of-way.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** **Approved by Voice Vote.**
- **00:59:29 Presentation: Community Enhancement Projects (CEP) Courthouse Square Maintenance**

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Representative for Community Enhancement Projects.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Overview of CEP's role in arranging and maintaining the Courthouse Square grounds and specialized stormwater gardens through J Crew, noting nearly \$130,000 annual expenditure across projects. Commissioners raised questions regarding line-item costs and contract increases.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion to table contract review. **Approved by Voice Vote.**
 - **00:43:32** (*Note: Transcript placement*) **Ordinance: Health Services Advisory Board Appointment**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** County Attorney John.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Adoption of an ordinance authorizing the county to appoint a member to serve on the governor's advisory board between health services and health service corporations, reflecting state statute changes.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** **Adopted by Voice Vote.**
 - **01:09:59 Ordinance: All-Way Stop at 75 South and Old Road**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Highway Department / Commissioners.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Proposal to establish an all-way stop sign at 75 South and Old Road to address traffic safety, heavy agricultural traffic, and upcoming road widening projects.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Notice of public hearing set for the next meeting. **Approved by Voice Vote.**
 - **01:16:35 Resolution: Disaster Declaration for April Storms**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Director Katil (Emergency Management) & Commissioners.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Report on the EF-2 tornado (April 2, 15.2 miles long, 200 yards wide, 125 mph peak winds) and straight-line winds causing significant damage (42 affected structures, 26 minor, 12 major, 9 destroyed, zero injuries/deaths). Commended AEP, highway department, and emergency services response. Presentation of Resolution No. 2025-06 for a local disaster declaration to qualify for State Disaster Relief Funds (SDRF).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Resolution No. 2025-06 **Passed Unanimously.**
 - **01:34:04 Financial Claims, Payroll, and Warrant Approvals**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Auditor's Office / Commissioners.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Review and questioning of various county claims, tax distributions, tax sale surpluses, and fund expenditures without detailed descriptions.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:**
 - Regular Claims: **Approved by Voice Vote.**
 - ARPA/Federal Claims (\$44,699.70 including RQAW): **Approved by Voice Vote.**
 - Payroll (\$3,260,000+): **Approved by Voice Vote.**
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5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

No members of the public signed up or spoke during the general open public comment period.

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff & Board Announcements:**
 - **Fairgrounds Events:** Reminder of upcoming private party events at the fairgrounds featuring fireworks on Wednesday/Thursday (training) and Saturday night, with public notifications to be posted.
 - **Highway Department Updates:** Report on road cut repair procedures (using washed stone and 53s for compaction before concrete pour). Condolences expressed for the passing of 10-year Highway Department veteran Mike.
 - **Health Department:** Health First Delaware County partnership funding application is live on the county webpage and Facebook; applications due April 30.
 - **Dispatchers:** Acknowledgment that next week is National Public Safety Telecommunicators Week (April 13-19).
 - **Payroll Study:** Commissioner requested County Attorney John draft an RFP to explore privatizing county payroll following a staff departure.
 - **Executive Session:** Commissioners discussed scheduling an executive session for personnel and economic development.
 - **Adjournment:** Motion to adjourn made and supported; **Approved by Voice Vote** (exact adjournment time not explicitly stated in transcript).
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